

Other chords

There are many variations of chords other than triads based on the standard degrees of the scale. Triads can have extra notes added to them or—in the case of the Neapolitan sixth—can be based on a flattened degree of the scale.

How do you make a seventh chord?

Seventh chords are one of the most common types of added note chord. They are formed by taking a triad and adding a note that is a major, minor, or diminished seventh above the root. Several types of seventh chords are possible from these combinations of triads and seventh intervals.

SEE ALSO

◀ 56–59 Intervals

◀ 124–125 Degrees of the scale

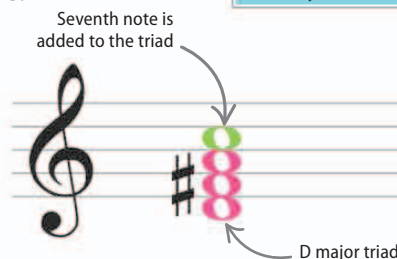
◀ 126–127 Triads

◀ 128–129 Inversions

◀ 130–131 Chord types

Chord symbols

148–149 ▶



◀ Seventh chord on D

This seventh chord, starting on D, consists of a D major triad and an added note a seventh above the root of the triad.

Type of seventh chord	Type of triad on which chord is based	Quality of interval between root of triad and added seventh note
major	major	major
minor	minor	minor
dominant	major	minor
(fully) diminished	diminished	diminished
half-diminished	diminished	minor
minor major seventh	minor	major

◀ Common types of seventh chord

These chords are named according to the type of triad on which they are based, and the quality of the interval between the root of the triad and the added seventh note.

Key

Major third	Perfect fifth	Major seventh	Diminished seventh
Minor third	Diminished fifth	Minor seventh	

△ D major 7th
This chord is a D major triad with an added note (C#) a major seventh above the root of the triad (D).

105

△ D minor 7th
Here the chord is a D minor triad with an added note (C) a minor seventh above the root.

106

△ D dominant 7th
This chord is a D major triad with an added note (C) a minor seventh above the root.

107

△ D diminished 7th
The chord is a D diminished triad with an added note (Cb) a diminished seventh above the root.

108

△ D half-diminished 7th
Shown here is a D diminished triad chord with an added note (C) a minor seventh above the root.

109

△ D minor major 7th
This chord is a D minor triad with an added note (C#) a major seventh above the root.

110